



SOME OF THE MPW AWARD WINNERS 1. Neerja Birla, Founder and Chairperson, Mpower 2. Aparna Purohit, Head of India Originals, Amazon Prime Video 3. Dr. Priya Abraham, Director, ICMR-National Institute of Virology 4. Hina Nagarajan, MD & CEO, Diageo India 5. Mahua Acharya, MD & CEO, CESL 6. Monika Shergill, Vice President, Content, Netflix India 7. Priya Nair, ED, Beauty and Personal Care, HUL 8. Vineeta Singh, CEO & Co-founder, SUGAR Cosmetics 9. Vishakha R.M., MD & CEO, IndiaFirst Life Insurance Company

Second is stickiness in the job. The attrition ratio of women is much lower than men, at least at Kotak. And it's something which we find quite fascinating," he said. That probably is the secret sauce to the 26 per cent share of women in the bank's workforce, which Kotak intends to increase to one-third in the next three years.

The session with Kotak was then followed by a fireside chat that Aaditya Thackeray, Maharashtra's Cabinet Minister of Tourism and Environment, had with Rahul Kanwal, Executive Director, *Business Today* and News Director, TV Today Network, on the subject "Women and the State: The Leadership Agenda". Calling the recent state elections, especially in Uttar

Pradesh, a "defining moment" for politics in India, Thackeray noted that women voted in huge numbers in the state in the recent legislative assembly elections, creating a new dynamism, and a new dynamic for governments. "And for us as governments, it is something for us to look back and think over if we are getting our policies for families right," adding that largely, what women voters go for are policies for families.

Following Thackeray's conversation, the Chairman and Editor-in-Chief of the India Today Group, Aron Purie, took to the stage for his address to the august audience. Purie said that having attended most of BT's MPW awards since when it began in 2003, "I can safely

say that I have literally seen the evolution of India's women leadership before my eyes." Unlike those early years when the listing was dominated by banking, and had a sprinkling of women from other sectors, today no sector dominates this list simply because women are succeeding everywhere. "That can only be good for the country and its economy."

The awards were then given away to the deserving winners by Thackeray, Kotak and Purie, and the evening then got more joyful with the celebrations also of the 30 years of existence of *Business Today*. **BT**

With inputs from Vidya S., Anand Adhikari, Prerna Lidhoo and Ashish Rukhaiyar